

Gobuster — Practical Tool Guide

Directory/file discovery, DNS subdomains, and virtual hosts, with wordlists, extensions, headers, cookies, and practical filtering.

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Usage note: Web-lab enumeration can generate substantial traffic. Choose wordlist size and thread count to match the authorized scope.

MODE

dir / dns / vhost

WORDLIST

Choose a list

FILTER

Status / length

VERIFY

Open the result

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1. Choose the mode

Mode	Goal	When to use it
dir	Directory/file discovery	Paths, pages, and extensions.
dns	DNS subdomain discovery	Subdomains that resolve in DNS.
vhost	Virtual-host discovery	Hostnames served by the same web server.

2. Directory enumeration

Start with a small wordlist and expand only if needed.

KALI TERMINAL — Basic

```
gobuster dir -u http://[TARGET]/ -w /usr/share/wordlists/dirb/common.txt
```

KALI TERMINAL — Extensions

```
gobuster dir -u http://[TARGET]/ -w [WORDLIST] -x php,txt,html
```

KALI TERMINAL — Show response length

```
gobuster dir -u http://[TARGET]/ -w [WORDLIST] -l
```

KALI TERMINAL — Selected status codes

```
gobuster dir -u http://[TARGET]/ -w [WORDLIST] -s 200,301,302,403
```

Note: 403 can still be important: the path exists but access is forbidden. Do not discard it automatically.

3. Headers / cookies / authentication

KALI TERMINAL — Custom header

```
gobuster dir -u http://[TARGET]/ -w [WORDLIST] -H "Authorization: Bearer [TOKEN]"
```

KALI TERMINAL — Cookie

```
gobuster dir -u http://[TARGET]/ -w [WORDLIST] -c "session=[VALUE]"
```

4. DNS mode

KALI TERMINAL — DNS discovery

```
gobuster dns -do [DOMAIN] -w [WORDLIST]
```

KALI TERMINAL — Custom DNS server

```
gobuster dns -do [DOMAIN] -w [WORDLIST] -r [DNS_SERVER]:53
```

5. VHost mode

Useful when the application depends on the Host header and the virtual host has no obvious DNS record.

KALI TERMINAL — VHost discovery

```
gobuster vhost -u http://[TARGET]/ --append-domain -w [WORDLIST]
```

If the lab uses an IP but the application requires a domain, add appropriate host mapping to `/etc/hosts` based on the lab data.

6. Performance and troubleshooting

Higher speed is not always better.

KALI TERMINAL — Threads

```
gobuster dir -u http://[TARGET]/ -w [WORDLIST] -t 30
```

KALI TERMINAL — Delay

```
gobuster dir -u http://[TARGET]/ -w [WORDLIST] --delay 200ms
```

KALI TERMINAL — Mode help

```
gobuster dir -h  
gobuster dns -h  
gobuster vhost -h
```

Note: If timeouts or rate limiting appear, reduce threads. Enumeration tests can create a large number of requests.

Prepared as a quick-reference companion to the canonical Arabic guide. Use only in labs or systems you are explicitly authorized to test.

References:

<https://github.com/OJ/gobuster>